

Kai Luzniak

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EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz

Expected June 2028

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science | GPA: 3.92/4.0 (Dean's Honors)

Activities: Tech4Good Lab Research Assistant, Gen.G Collegiate Ambassador, D1 Collegiate Overwatch Player, VSA Intern

EXPERIENCE

Northrop Grumman – Embedded Software Engineer Mentee

Sep 2023 – Jun 2025

- Developed embedded software in Python and C++ for a 4-Raspberry Pi scale-model smart home, automating soil moisture-triggered irrigation, motion-activated lighting, and motorized entry through connected sensors and actuators.
- Built the Cheshire Cat voice assistant in Python, using the OpenRouter API to process spoken commands and authenticate door-access requests, then MQTT/Mosquitto over a dedicated router to trigger the lock through a secondary Raspberry Pi.
- Led a 10-week Agile cycle as Scrum Master, coordinating tasks and 3 rounds of user testing to guide iterative development.

Boeing Defense, Space & Security – Technical Program Management Intern

Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

- Self-taught HCL Leap to develop a project management tool that surfaced Agile workflow training gaps, gathering requirements from program leadership and the data team before adoption by 100+ employees.
- Translated stakeholder reporting requirements into an Excel VBA workflow that automated data cleaning and report generation for a \$1.3M R&D initiative, saving 3+ hours of manual formatting per report and supporting leadership reviews.
- Interviewed 10+ software, mechanical, and cloud engineers to quantify software download delays, then proposed a cloud deployment model projected to reduce downtime by 70% and recover \$2M+ annually in engineering productivity.
- The proposal advanced through 3 presentation rounds to become a finalist in Boeing's LINC innovation challenge.

Code Ninjas – Coding Instructor

Oct 2024 – Jun 2025

- Mentored 100+ K–12 students in Unity (C#) and Microsoft MakeCode; led workshops on AI fundamentals & game design.

PROJECTS

Slug Gaming Website | *React, Tailwind CSS, JavaScript, GitHub Actions, GitHub Pages*

June 2025 – Present

- Developed a website using React, JavaScript, & Tailwind CSS, serving a 3,700+ member collegiate gaming organization.
- Led UI/UX decisions through a self-authored design document, aligning layout, branding, and user flows while raising the Lighthouse accessibility score by 20 points.
- Coordinated with 11 directors and 120+ players to maintain team rosters, bios, and graphics, deploying updates through GitHub Actions.

Cata (2D Roguelike) | *Project Lead, Unity (C#), AWS EC2, Mirror, Git, Jira*

Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Led a 6-person development team through sprint planning, task assignment, and code integration, introducing Jira and Cursor to support Agile and AI-assisted workflows.
- Developed online multiplayer in Unity (C#) with Mirror, implementing lobby creation, room joining, player spawning, custom network management, and client-server synchronization.
- Built movement, combat, round, power-up, health, and projectile systems, then deployed multiplayer playtests on AWS EC2; earned 1st Place – Game of the Year among Da Vinci CS Pathway studios.

Compass | *Angular, TypeScript, NgRx, Firebase, SCSS, Git*

Jun 2026 – Present

- Collaborated on a 5-person Agile team to build a goal-setting web application where authenticated users can create, organize, and save personal goals.
- Developed reusable Angular components in TypeScript and SCSS, connecting user interactions to NgRx state and Firebase-backed authentication and data persistence.
- Reviewed teammates' code and submitted pull requests through Git, incorporating peer feedback to maintain consistent component structure and application behavior.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Skills: Python, C, C++, TypeScript, JavaScript, C#, SQL, HTML/CSS, React, NgRx, Node.js, Express, Unity, Mirror, PostgreSQL, Docker, AWS EC2, MQTT, Git, Linux/Unix, Jira, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, OpenAI Codex